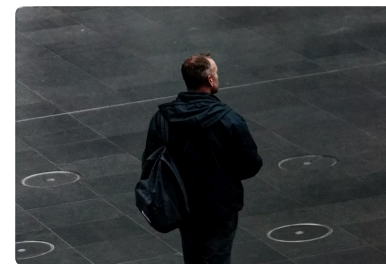


"If your business genuinely can't function for a fortnight without you, then you've failed as a leader."

ON RETURNING FROM TWO WEEKS AWAY, AND WHAT IT REVEALED



THE FOUR QUESTIONS TO ASK YOURSELF

01 IS IT BECAUSE THEY AREN'T CAPABLE?

Or because you've never given them the autonomy to be capable — have you invested enough time in developing them, or just found it quicker to decide everything yourself?

03 WHAT WOULD BREAK IF YOU DIDN'T ANSWER YOUR PHONE?

If the honest answer is "nothing, really", that's a sign of strength. If it's "everything", that's a structural problem, not a compliment.

02 WHAT ARE YOU ACTUALLY ADDING?

Every decision routed through you can feel like value. In reality, it often just means you've become the bottleneck the whole business waits on.

04 WHO WOULD MAKE THE CALL IN YOUR ABSENCE?

Not who would ring you first — who would actually decide, sign it off, and live with the outcome without needing your say-so.

A buyer prices key-person risk directly into the multiple they're willing to pay. A business that can't run without its owner is, to them, a riskier asset — and every year of that dependency is a discount on the valuation, not a neutral fact about how it's run. Reducing that reliance is not a soft management goal; it is one of the most direct ways a leader adds real, measurable value to the equity they're building.

WHAT GOOD DELEGATION LOOKS LIKE

- A leadership team that keeps the business moving while one person is away, regardless of seniority.
- Capable people equipped with the skills to make decisions, and the confidence to make them without approval.
- A short, genuinely exceptional list of things that warrant a call — not a standing expectation of one.
- A team trusted with real decisions long before the holiday, not just handed the phone number.
- A leader whose absence tests the business, rather than exposes it.

**THE LESS A BUSINESS DEPENDS ON YOU DAY TO DAY,
THE MORE SUCCESSFUL YOU'VE BEEN AS A LEADER.**